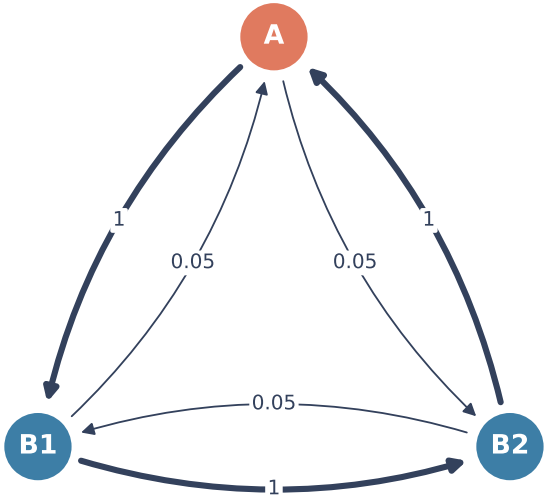
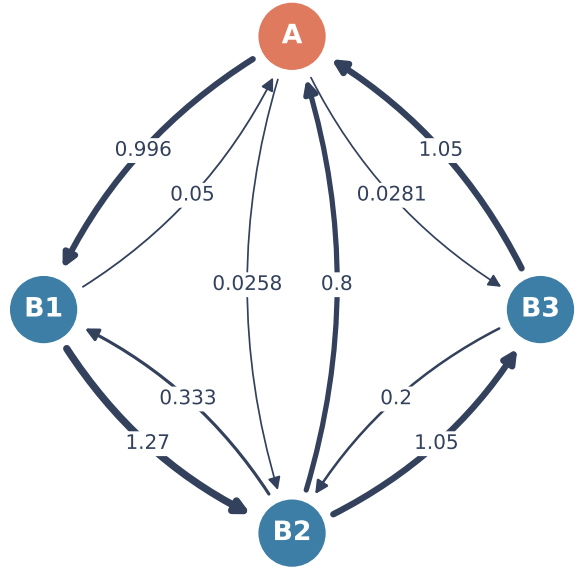
(a) cheapest three-state mechanism (ring)
entropy production 2.8459



(b) four-state mechanism Q_*
entropy production 2.7731



Both produce exactly the same observed A/B signal at q = 1/20. Arrow labels are transition rates; arrow width grows with rate.